AI for App Building

Module 1
Discover vibe coding

Module 2
Learn how to vibe code

- Learn how to build a custom AI tool
  Video • 4 min
- Develop functional apps to handle manual tasks
  Reading • 2 min
- Build with AI: Tie breaker app for better decision making
  Lab • 12 min
- Build with AI: Brand builder app to visualize any product
  Lab • 12 min
- Build with AI: Interactive dashboard to uncover data insights
  Lab • 12 min

Module 3
Create your app using AI Studio

- Identify tasks for your app
  Reading • 2 min
- **Evaluate your workflow to build an app**
  Reading • 8 min
- Ammaar, what's your pro tip for building apps?
  Video • 1 min
- Build with AI: A custom app to help you at work
  Lab • 12 min
- Ammaar, can AI models be combined?
  Video • 36 sec
- Measure the impact of your app
  Reading • 2 min
- Course challenge
  Graded Assignment • 10 min
- Claim your course completion badge
  Reading • 2 min
- Get started on the next course
  Reading • 10 min
- Resources for Google AI Professional Certificate graduates
  Reading • 2 min
- End-of-course survey
  Ungraded Plugin • 15 min

Evaluate your workflow to build an app

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The worksheet you completed helped map out your workflow and identify tasks where an app might provide the most value. Now you'll need to evaluate which of those tasks meet the technical requirements.

These questions aren't meant to define hard and fast rules, but they can help you feel confident your app will work and ensure you don't hit any technical roadblocks once you start building.

Question 1: Does the task solve part of a broader, more complex problem or workflow?

If the identified task is disconnected from your broader workflow, building an app for it may have limited benefits. Instead, try prompting Gemini to help you with the isolated task.

If the identified task is part of a bigger workflow, like a specific step in your vendor evaluation process, consider building an app. The effects of that solution will benefit not just that specific task, but also the tasks that come before and after it.

Let's examine how the Tie Breaker app does this. It analyzes and compares options, which is a step within a larger workflow of decision making.

Question 2: Can you outline a clear, step-by-step process for solving this problem?

If you can break down your process into clear, repeatable steps, you're in good shape for building an app. If your process is vague or undefined, pause and map it out first. Unclear steps can lead to ineffective apps.

Consider how the Marketing Materials Generator app follows a set of steps. First, we describe what we want an image of. Then, AI generates the image. Lastly, AI generates a custom set of creative assets across different surfaces, like a poster, social media post, or website. Each step is distinct and repeatable, regardless of the image you want to generate or how you might use it.

Question 3: Does the process involve consistent inputs and outputs?

An app needs predictable patterns to work reliably. The task should start with the same type of information (the input) and always produce the same type of result (the output). If the types of inputs you enter or the outputs you want to produce will change, your task is probably not suitable for an app. In those instances, you should prompt Gemini to help you with the task.

Think about the inputs and outputs in the Interactive Dashboard app. A spreadsheet goes in, and a graph comes out. Each time you use it, you're giving it the same type of input (spreadsheet) and getting the same type of output (graph). The data in the spreadsheet or the shape of your graph may change, but your inputs and outputs are consistent.

Question 4: What's the complexity level?

If your app can function independently using only the information you give it, keep going. However, if your app requires access to tools like calendar or email or needs to connect to other platforms, websites, or software, consult an expert to make sure your app idea is feasible and safe.

Notice how the apps we built hit the right complexity level:

- The Tie Breaker app doesn't need access to other tools. You just describe what options you need help analyzing.
- The Marketing Materials Generator doesn't store inputs and outputs long-term. It creates an image based on your request, but doesn't build a library of your past images. If you want a new image, the old one gets replaced.
- The Interactive Dashboard doesn't connect to other platforms. You upload your spreadsheet to the app, and Google AI studio turns that into an interactive dashboard with many different types of visualizations.

Use these four questions to evaluate each task in your worksheet. Which ones check all four boxes? These are your best candidates for building a valuable app that will save you time, increase the quality of your work, and give you more space for strategic thinking.

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